PRE-RELEASE

eCH-0309 – Animal movement data

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Summary

This document describes the data of the animal movement database (TVD) semantically, so that specialists without in-depth IT knowledge can also gain a better understanding of the data.

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Note

This document uses a gender-neutral formulation when referring to persons. This is based on the guidelines (German) of the Federal Chancellery. Depending on the situation, paired forms (citizens), gender-abstract forms (insured person), gender-neutral forms (insured person) or paraphrases without personal reference are used. The generic masculine (citizen) is not permitted. Full forms are used in continuous texts, i.e. in texts consisting of formulated sentences. Short forms can be used in abbreviated text passages, namely in tables. The short form is used with a slash but without an ellipsis (referent). Gender asterisks and similar spellings are not used.

1 Introduction

1.1 Status

In progress: Use is permitted only within the technical group and the Experts' Committee.

1.2 Field of application

This document describes the data of the animal movement database (TVD) semantically, so that specialists without in-depth IT knowledge can also gain a better understanding of the data.

1.3 Animal movement reporting in Switzerland

In the 1990s, Swiss agriculture and the food industry were severely challenged by the animal disease BSE. When the realisation that the disease could be transmitted from animals to humans was confirmed in 1996, this caused great uncertainty. Expectations regarding the safety of food of animal origin rose as a result, as did awareness of the importance of food control. The approach «from stable to table» became established. Risk-based surveillance, seamless traceability of farm animals, control of animal movements, the obligation to declare origin and quality controls throughout the production and processing chain have formed the basis for a high standard of food safety ever since [Bundesrat 2015].

The BSE experience led to the establishment of a national animal movement database (TVD) in 1999. Article 7a and Articles 13–15 of the Animal Diseases Act [TSG] and Title 2, Sections 1, 1a and 2a of the Animal Diseases Ordinance [TSV] set out the basic legal provisions on the identification/marking and the registration of farm animals as well as the associated reporting obligations. They follow European legislation on the same subject [EUR-Lex] (Regulation (EU) 2016/429 on transmissible animal diseases; Delegated Regulation (EU) 2019/2035 on establishments keeping terrestrial animals and hatcheries, and on traceability).

While only cattle were subject to reporting from 1999, pigs and equids followed from 2011, although pigs are to this day not reported as individual animals. From 2014 and 2020 respectively, the obligation to report to the TVD also applied to small ruminants (sheep and goats). At the beginning, in 2014, this concerned only the slaughterhouses. Since 2014 there has also been an obligation to report poultry [TVD-Verordnung, version of 1 January 2014, p. 20]. Since January 2020, keepers of small ruminants have been included in individual animal reporting as well [IdTVD-V, Annex 1]. The identification and marking of cloven-hoofed animals with ear tags, the individual registration of cattle, sheep and goats in the TVD, and the reporting of animal arrivals, animal departures (an animal leaves a holding alive), births, imports, exports, slaughter, on-farm slaughter and death (an animal is deregistered as no longer living) are mandatory for all animal keepers in Switzerland [TSG, Art. 14 and 15a]. Reports are also subject to statutory reporting deadlines [TSV, Art. 14].

The TVD is part of a system landscape spanning agriculture, veterinary affairs and food safety. The central entry point is the Agate portal [Agate], with the agricultural policy information system AGIS [AGIS] at its centre. Figure 1 shows the IT systems and organisations around the TVD and the data that flows between them.

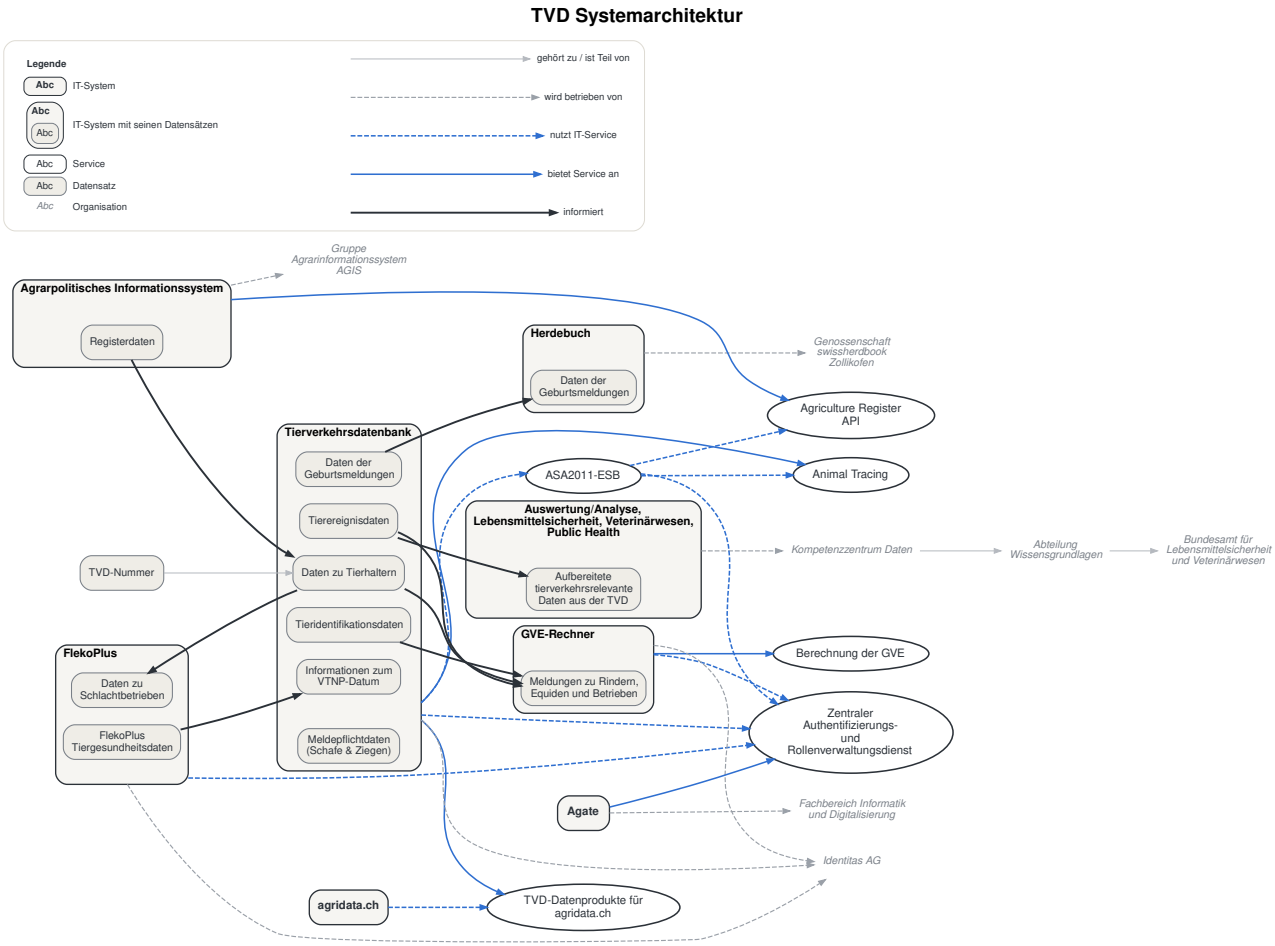


Figure 1: System landscape of the TVD. IT systems, services and organisations around the animal tracing database and the data flows between them. The figure is available in German only.

The Ordinance on Identitas AG and the animal movement database [IdTVD-V] further sets out the content relating to animal movements, the tasks of Identitas AG and the rights of access to the data. The importance of identifying/marking farm animals goes far beyond the subject of animal disease and therefore also found its way into agricultural legislation [LwG] (Agriculture Act LwG, Articles 165g, 177 and 185) and various associated ordinances. The animal movement data have become an indispensable component in implementing agricultural policy measures, for example animal-related direct payments [DZV, Title 2, Chapter 5, Sections 7–9], the determination of nutrient flows or agri-environmental monitoring [Agrarumweltmonitoring]. The data also serve as a basis for the structural survey of Swiss agriculture [STRU] and for agricultural statistics in general [Agristat].

Animal movement reporting quickly became established along the entire food value chain as well. Programmes with animal welfare, traceability and origin commitments rely on it [Labelbase; Proviande]. The variety of animal information from animal movement reporting is also reflected in the publicly available datasets of the Tierstatistik open data platform [Tierstatistik].

The technical interface description in this document is based on the technical service description AnimalTracing v1.32 and on the openAPI specification v1.0 [AnimalTracing openAPI].

1.4 References

Interfaces: AnimalTracing API, technical service description AnimalTracing

2 Namespaces

Table 1 lists the prefixes and namespaces used in this document. A prefix stands for a namespace IRI, the common beginning of the IRIs of a vocabulary. The Turtle specification describes how such *prefixed names* are resolved [Turtle].

Table 1: Namespaces used in eCH-0309 – Animal movement data.

Prefix	Namespace
:	https://agriculture.ld.admin.ch/eCH-0309/1/
codelist:	https://agriculture.ld.admin.ch/eCH-0309/1/codelist/
eCH-0261:	http://www.ech.ch/xmlns/ech-0261/1/
genus:	https://agriculture.ld.admin.ch/eCH-0309/1/genus/
schema:	http://schema.org/
xsd:	http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema#

3 Data Model

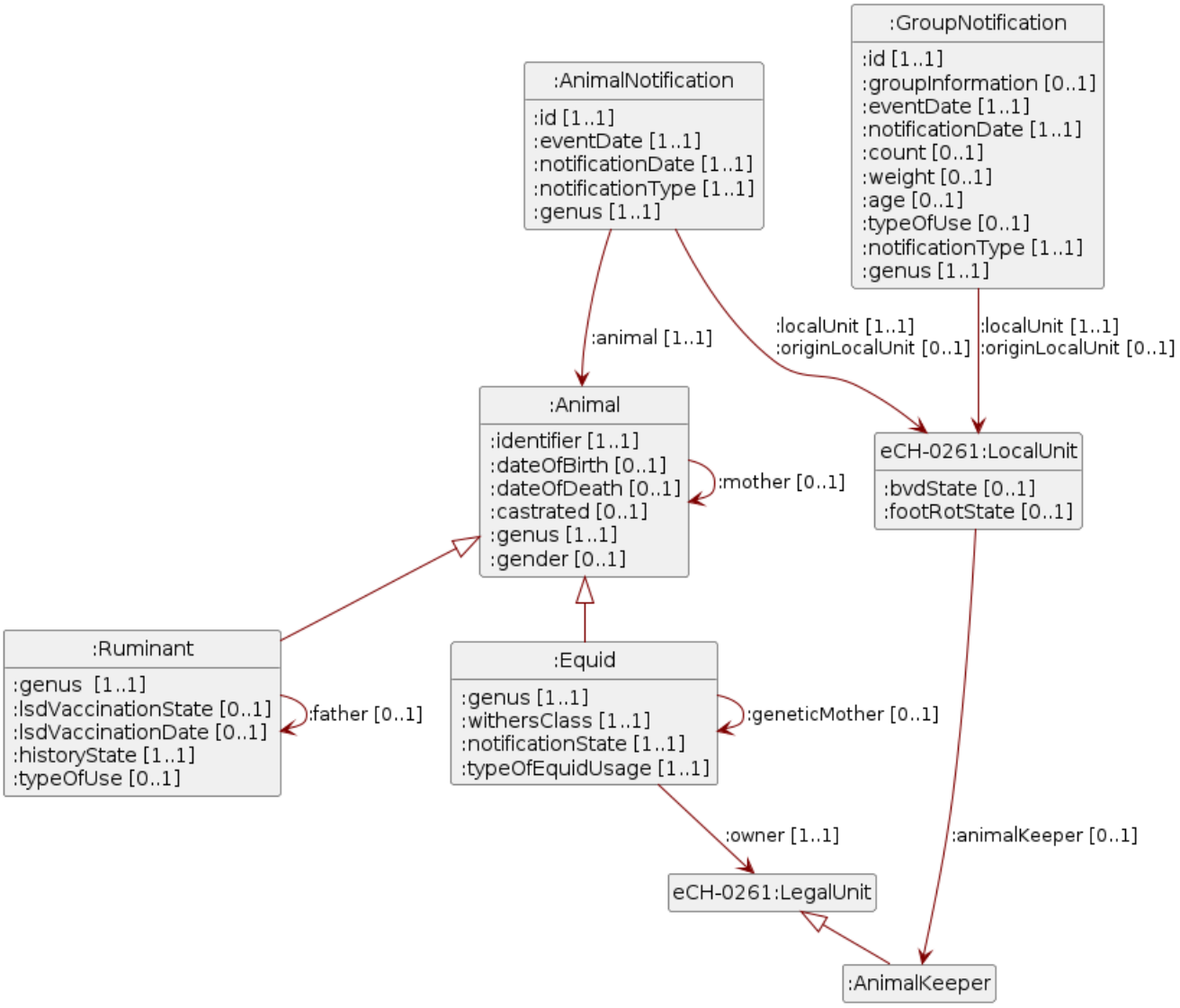


Figure 2: UML diagram of the eCH-0309 data model.

Figure 2 shows the classes of the data model and their relationships. Each rectangle is a class and the lines inside it are its attributes; the square brackets state how many values are permitted, from the minimum to the maximum — `[1..1]` means exactly one value, `[0..1]` at most one. An arrow leads to the class being referred to and carries the name of the relationship; several relationships between the same two classes share one arrow. The line with the triangle connects a class to its superclass, at which the triangle points: a ruminant and an equid are each an individual animal and have, in addition to the attributes shown, all attributes of the individual animal, which are not repeated in the diagram. Attributes with a code list are drawn like all the others; the permitted values are given in Section 4. The diagram states neither datatypes nor descriptions; those follow in the sections on the individual classes.

3.1 Legal unit

A legal unit as defined in eCH-0108 is a legal entity (e.g. a public limited company or a limited liability company), a partnership (e.g. a general partnership) or a self-employed natural person that is subject to the federal act on the business identification number (UIDG) and has an entry in the UID register. It identifies, for example, the taxable entity for the tax authorities or the person liable for social insurance contributions. The legal unit is identified by its UID. Only where the enterprise is a «sole proprietorship» is the farm manager at the same time a natural person. The master system for this data is the FSO's UID register; the agricultural information system obtains the data from that register through an interface. The animal keeper and the equid owner are the two forms of legal unit that occur in this document. The attributes are described in eCH-0261, chapters 3.1 and 3.2, and in eCH-0108, chapter 3.1.

3.1.1 Overview

Class eCH-0261:LegalUnit

3.2 Animal keeper

A farm manager (Bewirtschafter) is a legal unit as defined in eCH-0108 that bears the business risk for a farm (LBV Art. 2). The animal keeper is a form of farm manager that keeps animals (LBV Art. 11a) and therefore requires a local unit (animal holding). Responsibility for reporting lies with the animal keeper for all animal categories except equids; for equids it lies with the owner. The attributes are described in eCH-0261, chapters 3.1 and 3.2.

3.2.1 Overview

Class :AnimalKeeper

3.3 Local unit

A local unit as defined in eCH-0108 is a facility at a given location where an economic activity is carried out. A local unit has a BUR number and is always assigned to a legal unit (or enterprise). The local unit is identified by its BUR number. A local unit may consist of one or more buildings. The EGID assigned to the BUR number refers to «the centre» of the local unit, that is, its main building. This definition is taken from eCH-0108, chapter 1.5; the agriculture-specific additions are described in eCH-0261, chapters 3.3 and 3.4. In the TVD, local units are called «animal holdings» and are additionally identified by their TVD number.

3.3.1 Overview

Class eCH-0261:LocalUnit

3.3.2 Properties

Description	Details	Cardinality
Animal keeper (:animalKeeper): Assignment of the local unit to the animal keeper. According to eCH-0108, chapter 1.5, a local unit is always assigned to a legal unit (or enterprise); the master data of the local unit carries the optional attribute «mainUid» holding the UID of the main legal unit. Because the animal keeper is only a special form of the legal unit, this assignment is not mandatory.	• Type: Animal keeper	0..1
BVD status (:bvdState): BVD status of the local unit, for the genus cattle.	• Type: Text (xsd:string) • Values: `Undefined`, `Blocked`, `AnimalBlocked`, `NotBlocked`, `ConditionalBlocked`, `BvdFree`, `NotBvdFree`, `NotBvdFreeBlocked`	0..1
Footrot status (:footRotState): Footrot status of the local unit, for the genus sheep.	• Type: Text (xsd:string) • Values: `Undefined`, `Free`, `NotTested`, `Blocked`	0..1

3.4 Individual animal

An individually identified farm animal. In the animal movement database, animals of the categories cattle, sheep, goats and equids are recorded as individual animals; they are uniquely identified by their ear tag number, or by the UELN in the case of equids. No individual animals are kept for pigs and poultry, only group notifications. Every individual animal is either a ruminant (cattle, sheep, goat) or an equid; this class describes the information that applies to both.

3.4.1 Overview

Class :Animal

3.4.2 Properties

Description	Details	Cardinality
Mother (:mother): An individual animal has at most one mother animal.	• Type: Individual animal	0..1
Identifier (:identifier): Ear tag number, or UELN for equids	• Type: Text (xsd:string) • Length: ≤ 15 characters	1..1
Genus (:genus)	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Genus	1..1
Gender (:gender)	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Gender	0..1
Date of birth (:dateOfBirth)	• Type: Date (xsd:date)	0..1
Date of death (:dateOfDeath)	• Type: Date (xsd:date)	0..1

Description	Details	Cardinality
Castrated (:castrated): Whether the animal is castrated. Only for cattle and equids.	• Type: Boolean (xsd:boolean)	0..1

3.4.3 Rules

Castrated is recorded only for cattle and equids, not for sheep and goats.

Every individual animal is either a ruminant or an equid.

3.5 Ruminant

Subclass of the class individual animal for animals of the genera cattle, sheep and goats. All attributes of the class individual animal also apply to ruminants; this class describes the additional information that is not recorded for equids.

3.5.1 Overview

Class :Ruminant

3.5.2 Properties

Description	Details	Cardinality
Father (:father): A ruminant has at most one father animal.	• Type: Ruminant	0..1
Genus (:genus)	• Values: ▸ Cattle (genus:Cattle) ▸ Sheep (genus:Sheep) ▸ Goat (genus:Goat)	1..1
Animal history state (:historyState): State of the animal history at the date of the query.	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Animal history state	1..1
Type of use (:typeOfUse)	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Type of use (cattle, sheep, goats)	0..1
LSD vaccination status (:lsdVaccinationState): Vaccination status against lumpy skin disease (LSD). Only for cattle.	• Type: Text (xsd:string) • Values: `Undefined`, `Vaccinated`	0..1
LSD vaccination date (:lsdVaccinationDate): Date of the vaccination against lumpy skin disease (LSD). Only for cattle.	• Type: Date (xsd:date)	0..1

3.5.3 Rules

The LSD vaccination status and date are recorded only for cattle, not for sheep and goats.

3.6 Equid

Subclass of the class individual animal for animals of the equid genus (horse, mule, hinny, donkey). All attributes of the class individual animal also apply to equids; this class describes only the additional, equid-specific information. For equids, responsibility for reporting lies with the owner rather than with the animal keeper. An owner is the legal unit that owns equids; the term is used for equid owners only.

3.6.1 Overview

Class :Equid

3.6.2 Properties

Description	Details	Cardinality
Owner (:owner): The legal unit that owns the equid. For equids, responsibility for reporting lies with the owner rather than with the animal keeper.	• Type: Legal unit	1..1
Genetic mother (:geneticMother): An equid has at most one genetic mother.	• Type: Equid	0..1
Genus (:genus)	• Required value: genus:Equid	1..1
Withers class (:withersClass)	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Withers class	1..1
Notification state (:notificationState): Equids carry a notification state of their own instead of the animal history state.	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Equid notification state	1..1
Type of use (:typeOfEquidUsage): Equids use a code list of their own: companion animal or farm animal.	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Type of use (equids)	1..1

3.7 Individual animal notification

An event concerning an individual animal. Events comprise movement notifications, notifications of basic data, changes to individual attributes of the basic data as well as final notifications. A notification always refers to the local unit at which the event took place and may in addition state the local unit of origin. Events are reported by the authorised persons, stating the animal holding to which the notification refers; for equids they are reported by the authorised persons of the responsible equid owner.

3.7.1 Overview

Class :AnimalNotification

3.7.2 Properties

Description	Details	Cardinality
Identifier (:animal): An individual animal notification refers to exactly one individual animal.	• Type: Individual animal	1..1

Description	Details	Cardinality
Local unit (:localUnit): BUR number of the local unit to which the notification refers	• Type: Local unit	1..1
Origin (:originLocalUnit): BUR number of the local unit the animal comes from	• Type: Local unit	0..1
ID (:id): Unique identifier of the movement, assigned by the system.	• Type: Text (xsd:string)	1..1
Genus (:genus)	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Genus	1..1
Notification type (:notificationType)	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Notification type	1..1
Event date (:eventDate): Date on which the event took place	• Type: Date (xsd:date)	1..1
Notification date (:notificationDate): Date on which the event was reported	• Type: Date (xsd:date)	1..1

3.8 Group notification

An event concerning a group of animals that cannot be identified individually. Group notifications are recorded for animals of the categories pigs and poultry; the individuals of such a group are therefore not known. Events are reported by the natural persons of the responsible legal unit, the animal keeper. They comprise housing notifications for poultry, movement notifications for pigs, and slaughter notifications for pigs (by head) and poultry groups (in kg).

3.8.1 Overview

Class :GroupNotification

3.8.2 Properties

Description	Details	Cardinality
Local unit (:localUnit): BUR number of the local unit	• Type: Local unit	1..1
Origin (:originLocalUnit): BUR number of the local unit the animal comes from	• Type: Local unit	0..1
ID (:id): Unique identifier of the movement, assigned by the system.	• Type: Text (xsd:string)	1..1
Genus (:genus)	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Genus	1..1
Group information (:groupInformation): Only for poultry, not for pigs: group information must be given for housing notifications.	• Type: Text (xsd:string)	0..1
Notification type (:notificationType)	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Notification type	1..1

Description	Details	Cardinality
Event date (:eventDate): Date on which the event took place	• Type: Date (xsd:date)	1..1
Notification date (:notificationDate): Date on which the event was reported	• Type: Date (xsd:date)	1..1
Number (:count): Number of animals moved in one movement (pigs/poultry)	• Type: Integer (xsd:integer)	0..1
Weight (:weight): Only for poultry: total weight of the animal group in kg for slaughter notifications. Slaughterings of pigs are notified in head (count).	• Type: Integer (xsd:integer)	0..1
Type of use (:typeOfUse): Type of use of the animal group (for individual animals it is held on the class «Einzeltier»)	• Type: schema:CategoryCode, see code list Type of use (cattle, sheep, goats)	0..1
Age (:age): Only for poultry, not for pigs: the age must be given in weeks for housing notifications.	• Type: Integer (xsd:integer)	0..1

4 Code lists

The following code lists define the permitted values of the corresponding attributes of the data model (Section 3). Each code list is modelled as a `schema:CategoryCodeSet` and each of its values as a `schema:CategoryCode`. How the codes correspond to the enums of the TVD interface is shown in Annex D.

4.1 Animal history state

State of the history of an individual animal on the query date. Not relevant for equids.

Table 2: Values of the code list Animal history state.

Code	Name	Description
`Lost`	Lost	The whereabouts of the animal are unknown
`NotDefined`	Not defined	No status has been set for the animal history
`NotOk`	Not ok	The animal history contains errors or gaps
`Ok`	Ok	The animal history is complete and correct
`TemporaryOk`	Temporary ok	The animal history is provisionally considered correct

4.2 Equid notification state

State of the notifications about an equid: whether a change of location or a transfer of ownership is still pending.

Table 3: Values of the code list Equid notification state.

Code	Name	Description
`LocationChangeAndAcquisitionPending`	Change of location and transfer of ownership pending	Notifications of a change of location and of a transfer of ownership have not yet been completed
`LocationChangePending`	Change of location pending	A notification of a change of location has not yet been completed
`Ok`	OK	No notification is pending for the equid
`OwnershipAcquisitionPending`	Transfer of ownership pending	A notification of a transfer of ownership has not yet been completed

4.3 Gender

Sex of an individual animal.

Table 4: Values of the code list Gender.

Code	Name	Description
`Female`	Female	Female animal

Code	Name	Description
`Male`	Male	Male animal

4.4 Genus

Livestock species whose animals are registered in the TVD and whose movements are notified.

Table 5: Values of the code list Genus.

Code	Name	Description
`Camelid`	Camelid	New World camelids
`Cattle`	Cattle	Animals of the genus *Bos* and water buffalo (*Bubalus bubalis*)
`Equid`	Equid	Animals of the horse family (horse, mule, hinny, donkey)
`Game`	Game	Farmed game in enclosures
`Goat`	Goat	Domestic goats
`Pig`	Pig	Domestic pigs
`Poultry`	Poultry	Domestic poultry, e.g. chickens, turkeys, ducks and geese
`Sheep`	Sheep	Domestic sheep

4.5 Notification type

Type of a notification about an individual animal, e.g. a movement, a birth or a slaughter.

Table 6: Values of the code list Notification type.

Code	Name	Description
`Arrival`	Arrival	Not for equids
`Birth`	Birth	Live birth of an animal
`DayStay`	Day stay	Not for equids
`DeathBirth`	Stillbirth	Not for equids
`Deceased`	Death	For equids: euthanasia
`Export`	Export	For equids: transfer of ownership abroad
`FirstRegistration`	First registration	For sheep and goats only
`Import`	Import	Import of an animal from abroad
`ImportAfterExport`	Import after export	Not for equids
`Leaving`	Departure	Not for equids
`LocationChange`	Change of location	For equids only
`OnFarmSlaughter`	On-farm slaughter	Not for equids

Code	Name	Description
`Slaughter`	Slaughter	Slaughter in a slaughterhouse

4.6 Type of use (cattle, sheep, goats)

Type of use of cattle, sheep and goats.

Table 7: Values of the code list Type of use (cattle, sheep, goats).

Code	Name	Description
`Milk`	Milk	Dairy cows, sheep and goats
`Other`	Other	Any use other than milk production, e.g. meat production

4.7 Type of use (equids)

Type of use of an equid; it determines whether the equid may be slaughtered for food production.

Table 8: Values of the code list Type of use (equids).

Code	Name	Description
`CompanionAnimal`	Companion animal	Equid that must not be slaughtered for food production
`FarmAnimal`	Farm animal	Equid that may be slaughtered for food production

4.8 Withers class

Classification of equids into two categories by their height at the withers.

Table 9: Values of the code list Withers class.

Code	Name	Description
`GreaterThan148cm`	Withers height above 148 cm	Equids with a height at the withers of more than 148 cm
`LessOrEqualThan148cm`	Withers height up to 148 cm	Equids with a height at the withers of at most 148 cm

5 Safety considerations

Information about the explicitly relevant legal bases or a note that during the implementation the relevant legal bases must be observed.

6 Disclaimer

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8 Annex A - References

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9 Annex B - Cooperation and Verification

Table 10: Authors and review

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10 Annex C - Abbreviations and Glossary

Table 11: Glossary of eCH-0309

Term	Description
Animal holding	In the animal movement database, local units are called «animal holdings»; they are additionally identified by their TVD number.
Farm manager	A legal unit that bears the business risk for a farm (LBV Art. 2). The animal keeper is a form of farm manager that keeps animals (LBV Art. 11a).
Home holding	For cattle, a home holding can be recorded in order to represent an animal's affiliation to an animal holding while the animal is located on another local unit.
Linked Data Service (LINDAS)	The official Linked Data service of the Swiss Federal Administration, acting as a triple store.
Reporting person	The person or persons who make notifications for an animal holding or for an equid owner.
Resource Description Framework (RDF)	A central standard of the World Wide Web Consortium (W3C) for modeling data structures on the Web. Information is represented as networked graphs rather than in traditional tables.
Triple	The basic structure of a statement in RDF, consisting of a subject, predicate, and object. *Broader*: Resource Description Framework

11 Annex D - Mapping to the TVD interface

For the code lists in Table 12, the code of a value is the member of the same name of an enum of the TVD interface AnimalTracing.

For notification type, the interface holds the notification types per livestock species in enums of their own, partly under other names. The following table shows which members of the interface correspond to a value; values without a corresponding value in the interface are not listed.

Table 12: Enums of the TVD interface from which the code lists take their codes.

Code list	Enum of the interface
Animal history state	`EnumAnimalHistoryState`
Equid notification state	`EnumEquidNotificationState`
Gender	`EnumGender`
Genus	`EnumGenus`
Type of use (cattle, sheep, goats)	`EnumAnimalTypeOfUse`
Type of use (equids)	`EquidTypeOfUsage`
Withers class	`EnumEquidWithersClass`

Table 13: Corresponding values of the code list Notification type in the TVD interface.

Code	Name	TVD interface

`Arrival`	Arrival	`EnumCattleNotificationType.Arrival`
		`EnumGoatNotificationType.Arrival`
		`EnumSheepNotificationType.Arrival`

`Birth`	Birth	`EnumCattleNotificationType.Birth`
		`EnumGoatNotificationType.Birth`
		`EnumSheepNotificationType.Birth`

`DeathBirth`	Stillbirth	`EnumCattleNotificationType.DeathBirth`
		`EnumGoatNotificationType.DeathBirth`
		`EnumSheepNotificationType.DeathBirth`

`Deceased`	Death	`EnumCattleNotificationType.Deceased`
		`EnumGoatNotificationType.Deceased`
		`EnumSheepNotificationType.Deceased`

`Export`	Export	`EnumCattleNotificationType.Export`
		`EnumGoatNotificationType.Export`
		`EnumSheepNotificationType.Export`

`FirstRegistration`	First registration	`EnumGoatNotificationType.FirstRegistration` `EnumSheepNotificationType.FirstRegistration`

`Import`	Import	`EnumCattleNotificationType.Import`
		`EnumGoatNotificationType.Import`
		`EnumSheepNotificationType.Import`

Code	Name	TVD interface

`Leaving`	Departure	`EnumCattleNotificationType.Leaving`
		`EnumGoatNotificationType.Leaving`
		`EnumSheepNotificationType.Leaving`

`OnFarmSlaughter`	On-farm slaughter	`EnumCattleNotificationType.YardSlaughter`
		`EnumGoatNotificationType.OnFarmSlaughter`
		`EnumSheepNotificationType.OnFarmSlaughter`

`Slaughter`	Slaughter	`EnumCattleNotificationType.Slaughtering`
		`EnumGoatNotificationType.Slaughter`
		`EnumSheepNotificationType.Slaughter`

12 Annex E - Changes in comparison to previous version

Version 1.0.0 is the first version of this document. There is therefore no previous version and no changes to report. Future changes per version will be recorded in the releases on GitHub.

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